

Playing with your letter and glyph objects, you can determine where your punctuation should go best. Try different ways of arranging your things until you find one you like.

How to Make Your Letters Look Better

Step 1

In this section, we'll look at different ways to use the Brush Tool to make a font. Let's look at four ways to improve your letters' shapes.

1. We haven't done anything. Our letter "s" would look like if we just used the image we traced. It's not smooth, but it has a strange charm.

2. After I used the Shape Tool, we got this next letter shape. It's been cleaned up and made smoother, but it's still not as smooth as the letters below.

3. The Pencil Tool was used to trace this third one (N). Set your Fidelity to Smooth and outline your letters as you see fit.

4. Finally, the Blob Brush Tool looks like (Shift-B). The Brush Tool can also give you a similar result (B). Both can be used to make lines work with pressure.

If you choose the Blob Brush Tool, you'll make font Illustrator objects for each letter. If you select the Brush Tool, you will make paths you can change using different brushes. I'll use the Brush Tool and a custom brush we'll make next.

Step 2

My custom brush is a Calligraphy Brush with the following options:

- Angle: 40°
- Roundness: 51%
- 6 point font, 6 point pressure range

Please remember that we're using a graphics tablet that responds to pressure. If you are drawing with a mouse or something other than a stylus, the Pen Tool (P) is probably a better choice.

Step 3

You'll learn how to design a font in this step. It's time to redraw your letters and make them better. Set each letter, one at a time, on a layer above your lowercase letter group to be visible and draw over them. Our custom brush looks like we wrote letters with a chiseled marker. Use similar characters to change the way other people look. We used the letter "b" to make all four